Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Analysing a practitioner without copying the page

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do we conduct rigorous visual analysis of a practitioner's work through annotated studies rather than biography copying?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: Why is drawing a quick 3-tone 'tonal map' thumbnail of an artwork so revealing?

Correct: Squinting to reduce the picture to dark, mid, and light shapes reveals the hidden compositional skeleton that makes the focal point stand out — Exactly! A tonal map strips away surface detail so you can see the master contrast plan.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Which of these notes belongs on a high-level practitioner analysis page? -> The practitioner places pure white shapes directly against deep indigo wash (12:1 contrast) to lock the viewer's eye on the central emblem (Yes! It analyses visual mechanics and explains the effect on the viewer.)

Q2: How do you 'squint-test' an artwork when making your Box 1 Tonal map? -> Half-close your eyes so fine details blur away and only the big dark, mid-tone, and bright shapes remain visible (Spot on. The squint test is the fastest way to read

value structure.)

Q3: What proves in Box 3 that you have 'adapted' the practitioner's method rather than just copying their picture? -> Your box 3 study uses your own original personal symbol while keeping the practitioner's tonal map and layering technique (Correct! New personal subject + borrowed structural/technical principle = authentic adaptation.)

Exit check answer

Question: What is the purpose of drawing a simplified 3-value 'tonal map' when analysing an artwork?

Correct: To reveal the underlying structure of darks, mid-tones, and lights that directs the viewer's eye to the focal point — Correct. Tonal mapping exposes the compositional engine of an artwork.